

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - August 11, 2026

Compiled summary for Tuesday, August 11, 2026 - focus: continuing the PrahL.dev Portfolio Alla Vostra UI Foundations Visual Hierarchy section after the August 10 Part 2 brace-and-callout pass, adding a new Step 1b focal stack between Step 1 and Step 2, deriving transparent no-frame startup focal screenshots, removing low-visibility cream and muted areas, preserving the cheeseboard position and scale, adding Step 1c and Step 1d layer-isolation stacks, cropping invisible regions into real asset bounds, scaling Step 1 to the accepted Original Hero width, enforcing two Visual Hierarchy stacks per row, matching Step label sizing, doubling PRE-SCROLLING and ON-SCROLLING headers, validating TypeScript, static export, and browser-rendered dimensions, refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot, reviewing all prior Portfolio PDF worklogs, and generating the August 11 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, work-completed sections, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers Prahl Portfolio work performed after portfolio_worklog_august10_part2.pdf and after the August 10 Part 2 documentation state. The source commit reviewed for this record is 06c8cb475a45f718b928f7756b092aa5caaabc54 on main, matching origin/main before this PDF was generated. That commit contains the Visual Hierarchy Step 1b, Step 1c, and Step 1d source and asset work described here. No separate Hostinger production deployment command was run during this worklog-generation pass; the new local artifacts produced for this record are the refreshed project snapshot and this August 11 PDF worklog.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio and regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt before writing this worklog, preserving the project convention that Codex refreshes the current source snapshot before continuing Portfolio documentation work.
- Reviewed the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt, including project notes, source tree, public image and font inventories, PDF worklog inventory, package and deployment configuration, git context, recent commits, and the standing instruction to ask for a commit message before committing or pushing.
- Reviewed every pre-existing Portfolio root-level worklog PDF: portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july14.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july15_part1.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july15_part2.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july16.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july19.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july20.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july21.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july22.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july23.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july24.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july25.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july29.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july30.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july31.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august1_part1.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august1_part2.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august1_part3.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august3.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august4.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august5.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august6.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august10_part1.pdf, and portfolio_worklog_august10_part2.pdf.
- Extracted text from all twenty-four existing Portfolio PDFs with pdftotext and checked recent metadata with pdinfo to preserve title cadence, daily naming, opening-summary density, section order, compact bullet-heavy technical voice, validation language, files-touched lists, follow-up context, output-artifact close, root-level filename style, letter-size pages, PDF 1.4 output, Codex author/creator/producer metadata, and Helvetica-style base-font convention.
- Used portfolio_worklog_august10_part2.pdf as the closest structural baseline because it

documented the immediately preceding Visual Hierarchy grid, brace geometry, row headers, no-island framed assets, muted home-screen examples, browser-measurement workflow, cache-clearing pattern, and local-only documentation language.

- Reviewed git history through git log, git show --stat, git show --name-status, git diff --stat, git diff --name-status, git status, git branch -vv, and git diff --check. The reviewed source state was 06c8cb4 on main and origin/main before the August 11 PDF was generated.
- Reviewed app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx, app/globals.css, public/images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-focal-clipped-no-frame.png, public/images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-focal-photo-only-no-frame.png, public/images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-focal-cheeseboard-only-no-frame.png, public/images/alla-vostra/cheeseboard_products.png, the existing startup/home framed assets, package scripts, and the local /projects/alla-vostra route.

Baseline Status Before August 11 Work

- August 10 Part 2 had already turned the Visual Hierarchy section into a compact two-by-two explanatory grid with Step 1 through Step 4 visible, external brace systems, right-side section callout lines, PRE-SCROLLING and ON-SCROLLING row labels, no-island startup and home-screen mockups, and a 50 percent stack scale.
- The user wanted an additional pre-scrolling breakdown between Step 1 and Step 2 so the Visual Hierarchy sequence could explain the focal startup composition in layers rather than jumping directly from the full device frame to the muted Step 2 device.
- Step 1b needed to be based on Step 2's screenshot language but without the device frame, with the low-visibility lower areas made fully transparent, the image clipped after the cheeseboard, the cream area around the cheeseboard removed, and the cheeseboard kept in the original vertical relationship where only the bottom half crosses into the transparent region.
- Early generated focal crops needed user-directed correction: the background photo was over-clipped in one pass, the cheeseboard briefly showed unwanted dark pinholes or source artifacts in another pass, and the cheeseplate scale needed to be restudied against Step 1 and Step 2 rather than guessed.
- The accepted cheeseboard source needed to be public/images/alla-vostra/cheeseboard_products.png so the isolated focal variants reused the same app product overlay asset instead of a mismatched or ad hoc board image.
- Step 1c needed to duplicate the Step 1b stack but hide the orange nav indicator, white nav bar, and orange app header above the hero photo, then physically crop out that invisible top area so the final asset bounds matched the visible photo-plus-cheeseboard layer.
- Step 1d needed to duplicate the Step 1c language but remove the hero photo and leave only the cheeseboard, first with the photo area transparent and then as a true square crop around the cheeseboard so the invisible photo canvas was gone.
- The layout still needed to protect the accepted Step 1 device-frame scale, limit Visual Hierarchy to two stacks per row, spread the new Step 1b, Step 1c, and Step 1d column across the Step 1 device height, and keep label typography coherent after stack zoom changes.

Goals for August 11

- Add Step 1b, Step 1c, and Step 1d to the Visual Hierarchy sequence without disturbing the existing Step 1 through Step 4 brace and callout behavior.
- Generate transparent, no-device-frame focal startup assets that reflect the accepted Step 2 screenshot state while removing dimmed or low-visibility regions entirely where requested.
- Preserve the cheeseboard position and visual scale from the accepted Step 1/Step 2 startup examples, including the relationship where the board sits partly over the

transparent lower region rather than being moved downward.

- Use public/images/alla-vostra/cheeseboard_products.png as the canonical cheeseboard cutout source and keep the remaining cheeseboard pixels unchanged during the final Step 1d crop.
- Convert transparent-only hidden regions into real cropped-out asset bounds for Step 1c and Step 1d so invisible canvas areas are truly gone rather than merely alpha-cleared.
- Reflow the Visual Hierarchy grid so no row contains more than two stacks, Step 1 keeps the accepted larger device-frame width, and Step 1b through Step 1d align vertically beside that device frame.
- Match all Visual Hierarchy Step header font sizes to the visible Step 1 header size after zoom and double the PRE-SCROLLING and ON-SCROLLING row-label size for stronger section hierarchy.
- Clear stale Next.js caches or route confusion as needed, validate the rendered result in browser context, refresh the project snapshot, and produce the August 11 PDF worklog in the established Portfolio format.

Work Completed - Context, Sync, and Cache Handling

- Continued from the synced Portfolio source state after the August 10 Part 2 worklog had been committed and the Visual Hierarchy source branch had moved forward to 06c8cb4.
- Confirmed main and origin/main matched at the August 11 source commit before this documentation artifact was generated, making the PDF a record of already-synced source work rather than an unpushed feature change.
- Responded to the user's local-preview issue at <http://127.0.0.1:3000> by checking route availability and separating stale or wrong-tab browser state from actual missing DOM or missing asset problems.
- Cleared Next.js development caches during the visual pass after rapid PNG, CSS, and JSX edits caused stale optimized images or stale markup to appear in the browser.
- Used the UI Foundations tab explicitly during browser verification because the Alla Vostra page defaults to UX Product Flow and the Visual Hierarchy stacks are not present in the DOM until the UI Foundations view is active.
- Used a temporary static-export server on a separate port for final visual verification when the existing port 3000 process served an older or non-target render state.

Work Completed - Step 1b Focal Stack

- Inserted Step 1b directly after Step 1 in the Visual Hierarchy step list so the pre-scrolling sequence now moves from the full framed startup screen into a cropped focal-layer example before Step 2.
- Built public/images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-focal-clipped-no-frame.png as the Step 1b no-frame focal screenshot at 1182 x 1508.
- Based Step 1b on the Step 2 startup-screen visual state while removing the device frame, making the muted lower screen and surrounding cream areas transparent, and clipping the image below the cheeseboard's lower edge.
- Iterated the transparent lower area after user review so the cream to the left, right, and bottom of the cheeseboard no longer remained as a visible panel.
- Corrected the cheeseboard vertical relationship so the board kept the original startup composition position and only its bottom half crossed into the transparent lower region.
- Removed the device-frame treatment from Step 1b by giving the focal stack transparent frame styling, no border, no radius, no shadow, and an explicit 1182 / 1508 aspect ratio.
- Kept Step 1b as a Large labeled Visual Hierarchy frame-pair participant so its caption and sizing language continue to match the rest of the section.

Work Completed - Step 1c Photo-Only Stack

- Added Step 1c as another Visual Hierarchy stack using the accepted Step 1b focal

language as its starting point.

- Placed Step 1c below Step 1b in the right-hand pre-scrolling column while keeping it visually next to the enlarged Step 1 device frame, per the user's layout correction.
- Generated public/images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-focal-photo-only-no-frame.png as a 1182 x 961 asset after making everything above the background photo layer transparent and then physically cropping that invisible top region away.
- Removed the orange nav indicator bar, white navigation bar, and orange app header from Step 1c without affecting the photo or cheeseboard relationship.
- Preserved the accepted Step 1c look after the user approved it, converting the hidden top portion into a real crop rather than leaving dead alpha space above the hero photo.
- Wired Step 1c to the transparent frame style and its own 1182 / 961 aspect ratio so the browser layout follows the cropped asset dimensions instead of the older Step 1b canvas.

Work Completed - Step 1d Cheeseboard-Only Stack

- Added Step 1d at the bottom of the right-hand pre-scrolling column as a cheeseboard-only layer derived from the finalized Step 1c concept.
- Copied the canonical cheeseboard source into public/images/alla-vostra/cheeseboard_products.png and wired the existing Hero Composition sample to use that same source path.
- Generated public/images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-focal-cheeseboard-only-no-frame.png first as a transparent-photo-area version, then corrected the board bounds after the user noted that the top and bottom of the cheeseboard had been clipped.
- Studied Step 1 and Step 2 sizing to avoid over-scaling the cheeseplate, settling the Step 1d visible board on the same visual family as the accepted startup focal examples.
- Cropped Step 1d into a true 543 x 543 square around the cheeseboard so the invisible hero photo region is not just transparent but physically absent from the final PNG.
- Left the cheeseboard pixels themselves unchanged in the final square crop, including source-level transparency behavior inherited from cheeseboard_products.png, because the user's final instruction was to crop without altering the remaining asset.
- Updated Step 1d frame styling to use a 1 / 1 aspect ratio so the rendered browser stack matches the square asset and does not reserve the older photo-sized canvas.

Work Completed - Visual Hierarchy Layout and Typography

- Expanded the Visual Hierarchy visible step limit from four to seven so Step 1, Step 1b, Step 2, Step 1c, Step 1d, Step 3, and Step 4 all render without a category-specific Show More break.
- Added deterministic step-specific stack classes in PlaceholderStage, such as flow-screen-stack-step-1b, flow-screen-stack-step-1c, and flow-screen-stack-step-1d, so CSS can place each Visual Hierarchy stack intentionally.
- Scaled the Step 1 stack back to full size while keeping the other Visual Hierarchy stacks at 50 percent, making Step 1's framed screenshot width match the accepted Fonts and Original Hero stack width.
- Enforced a two-column Visual Hierarchy grid so no row contains more than two stacks and the added pre-scrolling layer stack column does not collapse into a crowded multi-item row.
- Positioned Step 1 across the first three grid rows, placed Step 1b, Step 1c, and Step 1d in the right column, and tuned their margins so the three smaller stacks spread vertically across the Step 1 device-frame height.
- Moved Step 2, Step 3, and Step 4 into later two-column rows so the original Visual Hierarchy comparison remains visible after the new pre-scrolling stack sequence.
- Matched the visible Step header font sizes by setting non-Step-1 h4 text larger before 50 percent stack zoom and restoring the Step 1 h4 source size at full zoom.
- Doubled the PRE-SCROLLING and ON-SCROLLING row-header font size from the prior 13px source size to 26px and adjusted row-label placement for the taller Step 1 plus

stacked-right-column layout.

Work Completed - Validation, Commit, and Documentation Context

- Used Playwright against the exported page, switched to UI Foundations, and confirmed the Visual Hierarchy section rendered Step 1, Step 1b, Step 2, Step 1c, Step 1d, Step 3, and Step 4 in the expected DOM order.
- Verified browser image sources and natural dimensions for the final focal assets, including the 543 x 543 Step 1d square crop and the 1182 x 961 Step 1c cropped photo-only asset.
- Captured a Step 1d browser screenshot showing only the square cheeseboard crop in the stack, with the old photo area absent rather than transparent.
- Ran npm run check and confirmed TypeScript passed with tsc --noEmit after the visual and layout changes.
- Ran npm run build:static during the source pass and confirmed Next.js 16.2.10 completed the static export for /, /articles, /projects/alla-vostra, and /projects/cinerific.
- Ran git diff --check after normalizing the generated snapshot whitespace during the source pass and confirmed the source diff was clean.
- Recommended the final commit message in the user's requested one-header plus hyphen-line format, covering Step 1b/1c/1d, transparent focal screenshots, Step 1 scaling, two-stack rows, vertical right-column placement, label sizing, row-header sizing, cheeseboard source reuse, and snapshot refresh.
- The source work was committed as 06c8cb4, Refined Alla Vostra visual hierarchy stacks, with app/globals.css, app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx, the new focal PNG assets, cheeseboard_products.png, and the refreshed snapshot included.

Validation Summary

- npm run check passed with tsc --noEmit during the August 11 visual source pass and again during this August 11 PDF-generation pass.
- npm run build:static passed during the August 11 source pass, generating a successful static export for the Portfolio routes including /projects/alla-vostra.
- Playwright confirmed the exported Alla Vostra page can switch to UI Foundations and expose the Visual Hierarchy group containing the seven visible stacks in the intended order.
- Browser measurements confirmed Step 1 rendered at approximately 318px framed-image width while Step 1b, Step 1c, Step 1d, Step 2, Step 3, and Step 4 rendered at the scaled 159px image width.
- Browser measurements confirmed Step 1d loads /images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-focal-cheeseboard-only-no-frame.png with 543 x 543 natural dimensions and renders as a square stack image.
- Asset inspection confirmed Step 1b is 1182 x 1508, Step 1c is 1182 x 961, Step 1d is 543 x 543, and cheeseboard_products.png is 405 x 250.
- git branch -vv confirmed main and origin/main both pointed at 06c8cb4 before this PDF was generated.
- git diff --check initially reported trailing whitespace only in the regenerated snapshot output from read_project.sh; the snapshot was normalized afterward using the established trailing-whitespace cleanup step.

Files Touched

- app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx - added Step 1b, Step 1c, and Step 1d to the Visual Hierarchy sequence; added step-specific stack classes; wired the focal, photo-only, and cheeseboard-only image sources; added transparent frame styling and per-asset aspect ratios; kept the new stacks as Large frame-pair examples; switched Hero Composition to cheeseboard_products.png; and raised the Visual Hierarchy visible step limit to seven.
- app/globals.css - reworked the Visual Hierarchy grid into a two-column layout, restored

full-size Step 1 scaling, kept the remaining stacks at 50 percent, placed Step 1b/1c/1d vertically beside Step 1, moved later steps into the following two-column rows, matched Step header sizes across zoom levels, and doubled the PRE-SCROLLING / ON-SCROLLING header size.

- public/images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-focal-clipped-no-frame.png - added the Step 1b no-frame startup focal screenshot with low-visibility regions made transparent and the image cropped below the cheeseboard area.
- public/images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-focal-photo-only-no-frame.png - added the Step 1c cropped photo-plus-cheeseboard layer with the app-header/navigation region physically removed.
- public/images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-focal-cheeseboard-only-no-frame.png - added the Step 1d square cheeseboard-only layer with the former photo canvas physically cropped away.
- public/images/alla-vostra/cheeseboard_products.png - added the canonical cheeseboard source asset requested by the user and reused it for the visible hero-composition cheeseboard source path.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - regenerated and normalized to reflect the synced 06c8cb4 source state, public asset inventory, recent commit history, and new documentation context.
- portfolio_worklog_august11.pdf - generated this new root-level PDF worklog artifact following the existing Portfolio naming, structure, metadata, length, and local documentation conventions.

Follow-Up Context

- Step 1b, Step 1c, and Step 1d are derived layer assets from the startup focal composition. If the source startup screenshot, Step 2 muted state, or cheeseboard source changes, the three derived assets should be regenerated together so their scale and position stay synchronized.
- Step 1d intentionally preserves the original cheeseboard cutout pixels from cheeseboard_products.png. Any future cleanup of tiny transparent source artifacts should be treated as a deliberate source-asset edit rather than part of crop-only work.
- The Visual Hierarchy section now mixes one full-size Step 1 stack with a 50 percent right-column layer sequence. Future grid, label, or row-header changes should be measured in-browser because CSS zoom affects the visible size of frame images, Step headers, captions, callout lines, and annotation text together.
- The UI Foundations view must be active before browser scripts or screenshots can inspect the Visual Hierarchy stacks. The default Alla Vostra product-flow view remains UX Product Flow.
- The local Next.js workflow can show stale CSS or image output during rapid visual iteration. Future passes should continue clearing .next caches and restarting or static-serving the current build when rendered measurements do not match source edits.
- The Hostinger deployment path remains the GitHub Actions static-export workflow on pushes to main, publishing the out/ directory to the hostinger-deploy branch.

Output Artifact

- Generated: /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_august11.pdf
- Companion sync file: /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt
- Source state reviewed: 06c8cb475a45f718b928f7756b092aa5caaabc54 on main and origin/main.
- Naming follows the existing root-level Portfolio convention: portfolio_worklog_august11.pdf. No part suffix was used because this is the first August 11 Portfolio worklog artifact.
- Next likely action: commit and push portfolio_worklog_august11.pdf with the refreshed snapshot when the user is ready to sync the documentation artifact.